

LAB02 | Your SPSS field guide

MASY1-GC1015 • Student reference

Open your files, find your code, run with confidence.

SPSS environment routes: VCL, Windows, and Mac

Use one route for this lab. Keep the supplied CSV and `LAB02_SPSS.sps` in the same extracted folder. The syntax file is the reproducible graded route; the menu-only route at the end is an optional appendix.

VCL / AppStream

Upload with My Files, then work inside the remote Windows session.

Windows computer

Extract the download in File Explorer, then open desktop SPSS.

Mac computer

Extract the download in Finder, then open desktop SPSS.

 **Your sequence:** prepare the files → open Syntax Editor → run the chosen block → inspect Output Viewer → save your work.

Route 1: NYU VCL (AppStream Windows)

The streamed desktop is a separate Windows computer. Normal local copy/paste is not a dependable way to move a CSV or syntax file into it.

1. In the AppStream toolbar choose **My Files**, open **Home Folder**, and choose **Upload file(s)**. Upload the lab ZIP, or upload the CSV and `.sps` files separately.
2. Inside the VCL's Windows File Explorer, open **Home Folder** and extract the ZIP if you uploaded one. Keep the CSV and syntax together in one folder.
3. Open IBM SPSS Statistics from the VCL application launcher. In the tested session SPSS opened directly to the Output Viewer; no startup pop-up appeared. If a welcome/recent-files dialog appears in another session, close it with **X** or **Cancel** so you reach the normal SPSS window. Do not create a second copy of the data.
4. Choose **File > Open > Syntax** and open `LAB02_SPSS.sps`. In the `CD` line, replace only the folder path with the VCL path, commonly like `C:\Users\PhotonUser\My Files\Home Folder\<your-folder>`. Keep the quotes and final period.
5. Save a personal syntax copy as `LAB02_FirstName_LastName_NetID.sps` in the same VCL folder. Save the Viewer later as `LAB02_FirstName_LastName_NetID.spv`.

VCL transfer rule: If the clipboard does not move text from your Mac/Windows computer into the streamed desktop, do not keep retrying it. Upload the file through **My Files** and open the file from inside VCL instead. The AppStream **Clipboard** control is useful only when it visibly confirms a text transfer; it is not a replacement for uploading the data file.

Route 2: Windows desktop SPSS

1. Download and extract the student package to a local folder, for example `C:\Users\<you>\Downloads\LAB02_Student_Package\`.
2. Open SPSS, choose **File > Open > Syntax**, and open `LAB02_SPSS.sps`.
3. Change only the `CD` path to the extracted Windows folder. If a path contains spaces, keep the single quotes around it.
4. Save the syntax copy and output in the same folder. Local Windows copy/paste normally works, but using the supplied files keeps the path and data version auditable.

Route 3: Mac desktop SPSS

1. Download and extract the student package to a local folder, for example `/Users/<you>/Downloads/LAB02_Student_Package/`.
2. Open SPSS, choose **File > Open > Syntax**, and open `LAB02_SPSS.sps`.
3. Change only the `CD` path to the extracted Mac folder, for example `CD '/Users/<you>/Downloads/LAB02_Student_Package'`. Keep the quotes and final period.
4. Use **File > Save As** for the syntax and Viewer output. In some Mac builds the workbook command is **Save a Copy** rather than **Save As**; the file extension still matters.

Excel computer-route notes

The workbook steps are the same on both platforms, but the labels and shortcuts differ slightly.

- **Windows/VCL:** use **Data > From Text/CSV**, **File > Save As**, **Ctrl+S** to save, and **Ctrl+D** for Fill Down.
- **Mac:** use **Data > From Text/CSV** (or **Data > Get Data > From Text/CSV** on an older build), **File > Save a Copy** when Save As is not offered, **Command-S** to save, and **Command-D** for Fill Down.
- **VCL reminder:** these shortcuts act on the remote Windows session. Do not use a Mac Command key inside the VCL; use the Windows labels shown in the streamed desktop.

The three SPSS windows and how to switch

SPSS keeps the data, code, and results in separate windows. Use the SPSS **Window** menu; do not close the Viewer to get back to the code.

- **Syntax Editor:** choose the item ending in `LAB02_SPSS.sps – IBM SPSS Statistics Syntax Editor`.
- **Output Viewer:** choose the item beginning with `Output` and ending in `IBM SPSS Statistics Viewer`.
- **Data Editor:** choose the item showing the active dataset name. Use **Data View** for rows and **Variable View** for type, label, missing values, and measurement level.

 **Lost your code?** Open **Window**, then choose the entry ending in **Syntax Editor**. Keep the Output Viewer open so your results remain available.

The validated VCL session showed all three choices together under **Window**, with the current window marked by a check.

Run the syntax safely: All versus Selection

The green triangle is **Run > Selection** (also shown as `Ctrl+R` on Windows/VCL). It does **not** mean “run the entire file.”

- To run one lab block, highlight the complete block, including its import/filter command and its final period, then click the green triangle or choose **Run > Selection**.
- To run the complete syntax file, choose **Run > All**. This is the clearest choice for a clean first run.
- Do not press the green triangle with no highlighted block and assume the whole file ran. Re-select the complete block or use **Run > All**.
- Keep `TEMPORARY` and `SELECT IF` attached to the procedure they control. Separating them can change the denominator or produce misleading output.

 **One block:** select it, then use the green triangle. **Whole file:** choose **Run > All**.

After a run, switch to **Window > Output Viewer**, use the left outline to find the named block, and confirm that the expected table or chart is present. A green check/status message that SPSS is ready is not, by itself, evidence that the correct block ran.

Optional appendix: do the same checks through menus (no code)

This route is ungraded support and may use different defaults from the supplied syntax. Use the syntax route whenever the lab asks for a named SPSS block or an exact percentile/missing-value convention.

- 1. Import:** choose **File > Open > Data**, select the CSV, and complete the Text Import Wizard. Check that identifiers are strings, categorical fields are nominal/ordinal, numeric measures are Scale, and blank/sentinel values remain missing.
- 2. Frequencies:** choose **Analyze > Descriptive Statistics > Frequencies**. Move the categorical variable to the Variables box. Use **Charts** for a bar chart and **Statistics** only for measures that make sense for that variable.
- 3. Descriptives:** choose **Analyze > Descriptive Statistics > Descriptives** for mean, sample standard deviation, minimum, and maximum of a Scale variable.
- 4. Explore:** choose **Analyze > Descriptive Statistics > Explore**. Put the Scale variable in **Dependent List**, use **Plots** for a boxplot/histogram, and use **Statistics** for percentiles and outlier tables.
- 5. Charts:** choose **Graphs > Chart Builder** (or the Charts button inside Frequencies) and select the chart type that matches the measurement scale. Keep a zero baseline for count bars and label units.
- 6.** Read the table in the Output Viewer, then use **File > Export** for a PDF/PNG copy or **File > Save As** for an `.spv` file. Menu actions can be recorded as syntax with **Paste**, but students should still save the supplied syntax copy for the reproducible submission.

Quick recovery table

Problem	First recovery action
CSV cannot be found in VCL	Upload through My Files > Home Folder > Upload file(s) , extract inside VCL, and update only <code>CD</code> .
Code disappeared	Window > LAB02_SPSS.sps - IBM SPSS Statistics Syntax Editor .
Output disappeared	Window > Output... - IBM SPSS Statistics Viewer .
Green triangle produced the wrong output	Select the complete block, or use Run > All for a clean rerun.
Clipboard transfer failed	Stop retrying local paste; upload the file and open it inside VCL.
Counts/percentages disagree	Check measurement level, missing/sentinel rules, and the denominator before recalculating.

Help boundary: We can clarify an SPSS menu, a file-path error, or what a table means. We cannot validate a student's take-home conclusion before submission. Use the named checkpoint, troubleshooting section, and rubric for the final check.